DEADLOCK CHARACTER: BJÖRN



Presented to you by : Yassine, Jacob, Phil, Anton & Zheng.

GROUP MEMBERS AND ROLES

Yassine: Assistant & Actor

Jacob: Director & Camera Operator

Phil: Assistant

Anton: Mocap Technician

Zheng: Producer

WHY THIS PROJECT?

- Create a hero shooter character
- Enjoying Deadlock & its aesthetics
- Wanting to create a melee character
- Feasible with the props and area
- Vikings are cool



PRE-PRODUCTION PLAN



Ingame:

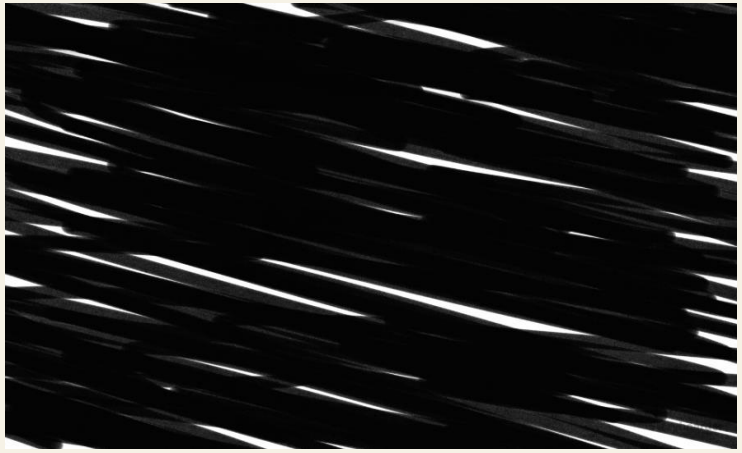
- Create a character possessed by his ancestor Viking
- Character has 4 melee-oriented abilities
- Uses a blunderbuss axe as weapon
- Prepared material:
  - Shoot-list
  - Background and notes on the character
  - Concept art

Cinematic:

- Cinematic follows the ancestor's revenge and death
- Mix of both fighting and nonfighting scenes
- Prepared material:
  - Shoot-list with cinematographic details
  - Background and notes on the character
  - Concept art
  - Storyboard
  - Rehearsal video



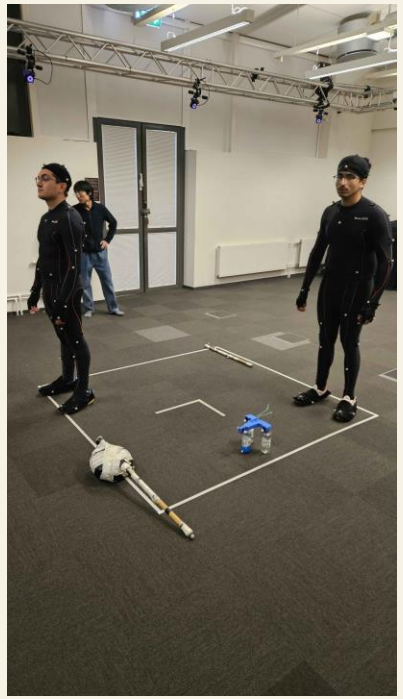
POST-MORTEM



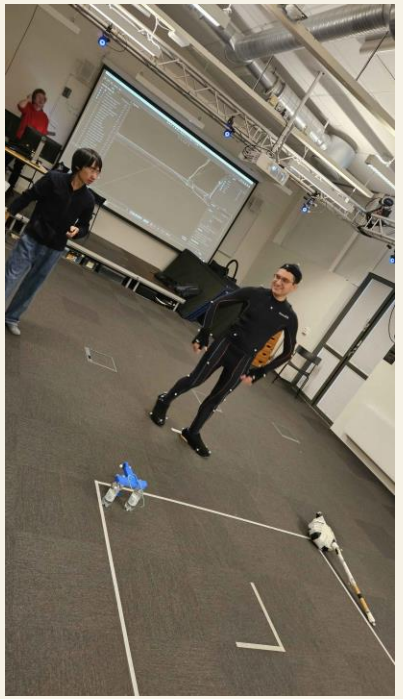
- 3 sessions, 3 to 4 hours per session
- Time for session planned by Producer
- around 15 animations per session

Changes:

- Some animations changed slightly due to occlusion
- Stance and distance were adjusted due to occlusion
- Cinematic shots were changed to prevent occlusion







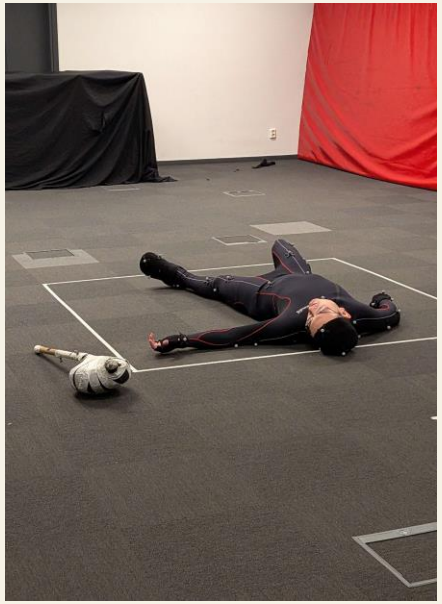
WHAT WENT GOOD AND BAD?

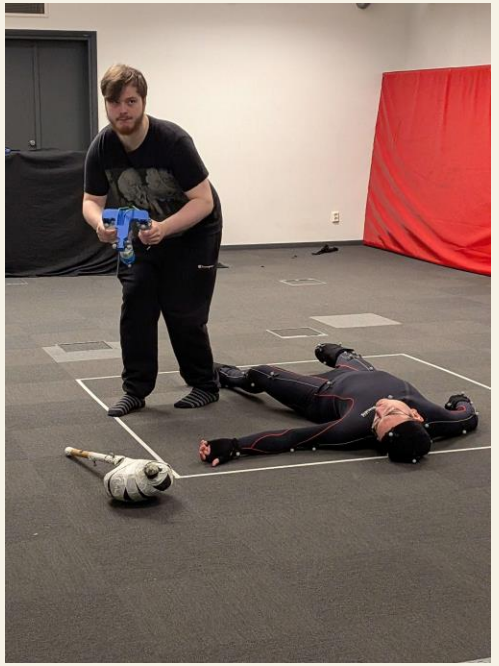
Good:

- Animations were easier to clean than A1
- Extra security takes helped us swap out bad takes in post
- We start reaching out for actors early

Bad:

- Some issues with calibration during ROM in session 2
- High stress with needing to try to plan for multiple actors to come in
- Extra security takes took us much more time during recording
- Actor 2 got sick, had a group member take their place





INDIVIDUAL SUMMARIES

Jacob:

- Preproduction is a lot on the director
- Learn from the mistakes of A1
- Clean data means way easier cleaning
- Recording & cleaning only gets faster with experience

Yassine:

- Over-exaggerating (making noises, breathing hard, over energetic movement) when acting even in mocap is necessary to capture unique body movements.
- Taking longer to calibrate body parts and also redoing takes pays off more in how easy the cleaning is later.
- As an assistant, it is good to give advice to the director while in a break.

Zheng:

- Raw data of high-quality reduces cleaning work
- Monitoring while recording helps a lot
- Plan the recording in advance especially with multiple actors

Phil:

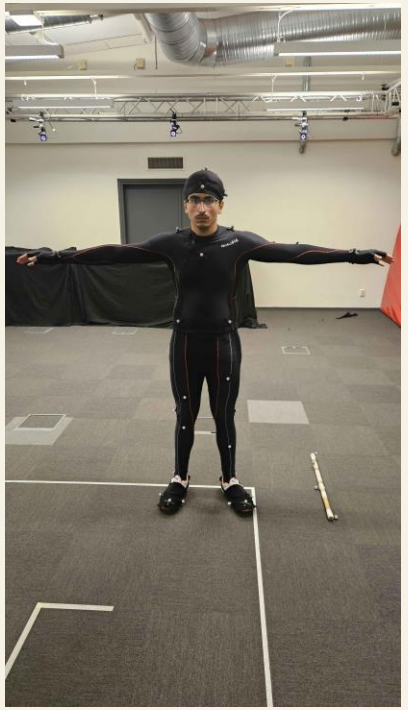
- Rough trails of markers are worth checking and usually need to be smoothened
- Cleaning is possible on most markers unless they move out of the recording zone

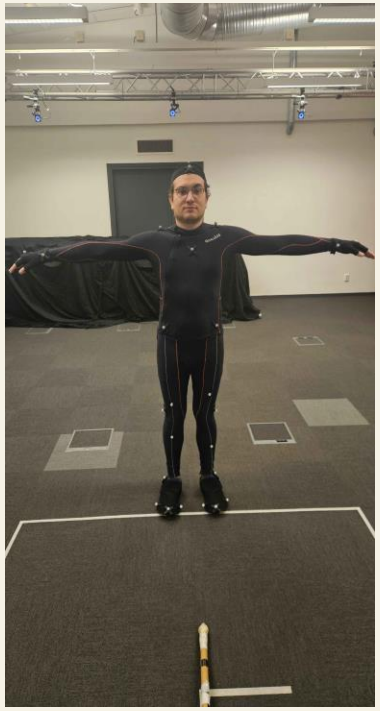
Anton:

- Being the technician makes you kind of a sub director.
- Wanding is hard when doing it alone.

TIPS FOR MOCAP

- Always do at least 1 security take
- Do not use covers or outside props if you can get away with it
- Avoid leaning, sitting, laying down... anything that occludes
- Remember the set up takes time still
- You're planning around 7 people





EFFECTS FOR THE FUTURE

- Know how the technology works
- Know the difficulties, restraints and limitations of the technology
- Have a feeling of when to do mocap vs keyframe animations
- Feel the mess in industry
- People don't know the limitations, but we do now
- Always consider the space needed for each animation



FINAL RECOMMENDATIONS & THOUGHTS

- Stress management is important
- "Good enough" needs to be ingrained
- Communicate with your staff as much as you can
- Do the recordings early to not fall behind
- Always have a plan B

